airbnb

Stay Mindfully, Belong Responsibly



The Mentalists (team 4)

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Why caring for every stay matter?

Every stay leaves a trace: a memory, a feeling, small impacts...

Belonging isn't about comfort anymore; it's about caring in the homes we stay in and the planet that welcomes us.

The issue and why it matters

Guest patterns

Leave lights on, the heating running, or any other appliances powered, of course not on purpose, but automatically.

Hospitaly sector key data

Consumes around 97.5 TWh of energy every year.
Switching to LEDs cuts electricity use by up to 85%
Efficient water use can save up to 50%

How guests think (System 1 and 2)

System 1: having fast and automatic thinking.
System 2: that is slower and reflective in making decisions.



Main challenge

Speak to System 1 through simple, identity-based signals that make sustainable behaviour feel natural, effortless, and part of who they are

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The Core Behavioral Change



Guests seek: comfort, freedom, ease – not rules

Current issue: signs feel moralising/restrictive, triggers resistance + guilt

Behavior is simple but identity Isn't

People reject instructions , embrace identities

New mindset: "I am a mindful guest"

Replace rules with identity cues

Sytem 2

Effort

"I should turn off the lights"

→

System 1

Instinct

"I am a Mindful guest in this home"

EHL Insights. (2019, June 28). *Why Do People Use Airbnb?* Ehl.edu; EHL Holding SA. https://hospitalityinsights.ehl.edu/why-do-people-use-airbnb
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STAY MINDFULLY



- **Liking** - Warm, friendly tone
- **Authority** - Airbnb's sustainability leadership
- **Social Proof** - Increasing guest ratings on profile.
- **Consistency** - People act in line with their chosen identity
- **Reciprocity** - Host appreciation
- **Scarcity** - Exclusive badge tiers
- **Unity** - Together, we are a community of Respectful Stayers.

Renascence. (2024). *How Airbnb redefines customer experience (CX) through community and authenticity*. Renascence Journal. https://www.renascence.io/journal/how-airbnb-redefines-customer-experience-cx-through-community-and-authenticity
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Why will this work?

System 1

- Builds pride, belonging, and instant association
- Creates automatic, habitual mindful behaviour

System 2

- *“I want to be a good guest. I want to care.”*

Social Identity Theory

- Sustainability becomes an expression of Airbnb community identity

Expected Impact

15-20% reduction in energy waste

Higher guest satisfaction

Stronger host-guest relationships

Stronger reputation for mindful, responsible travel



- Fritze, M. P., Franziska Völckner, & Melnyk, V. (2024). EXPRESS: Behavioral Labeling: Prompting Consumer Behavior through Activity Tags. Journal of Marketing. https://doi.org/10.1177/00222429231213011
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Conclusion

- People waste energy without meaning to
- When guests see themselves as Eco-Guests or Planet Friends, their behavior naturally changes.
- Stay Mindfully helps Airbnb lead by making mindful choices feel easy and natural.



Thank You!



Refernces

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